Gandhi and that he was there to click a picture. In reference to the kurta-pyjama-clad man, his explanation was that he was a ‘journalist’, thus clearly establishing all three were connected.[2]

It was closing time for the Rain Tree’s kitchen. A staff gently inquired if Anirudhya and his guest would like to order anything more. The two were down four bottles of beer. Anirudhya had had his dinner before Verma had showed up. He got a club sandwich packed for his friend. The problem started when it came to settling the bill. Verma insisted that he pay for it. Eventually Anirudhya convinced him to go for it the next time. Verma took a taxi and left. Anirudhya called his IB contact and left a message.

Next morning, the IB contact dropped a sealed envelope at his hotel. It contained information on Madras-based media personnel known to be sympathetic to the LTTE. Subha Sundaram was among them. He had lent his studio to LTTE propagandist Baby Subramaniam for the brainwashing of young Tamil minds. Subramaniam was close to the LTTE supremo Prabhakaran too. Sundaram was politically well connected in India and Sri Lanka both. He had visited Jaffna in March 1990 along with a Tamil Nadu-based journalist and had met Prabhakaran. He had also been in touch with other LTTE leaders, such as Anton Balasingham, Kasi Anandan and Kittu, the head of LTTE’s international affairs. In January 1991, Sundaram had written to Kittu and offered his services to the ‘protector of Tamils Thalapathi Prabhakaran’. The sealed envelope dropped at my hotel had also highlighted the fact that photojournalist Ravi Shankar and Haribabu both knew one Bhagyanathan, who had been gifted a printing press by Subramaniam. Anirudhya made it a point to dig up more on Subramaniam. He could be linked to the assassins if the LTTE indeed turned out to be responsible for Rajiv Gandhi’s assassination.